

Static GK Test -4

Q1. Los Angeles Clippers and Portland Trail Blazers are _____ teams.

- A) Women's Tennis
- B) Men's Basketball**
- C) Women's Hockey
- D) Men's Volleyball

Solution: 20.(b) Los Angeles Clippers and Portland Trail Blazers are Men's Basketball teams. Basketball, game played between two teams of five players each on a rectangular court. Basketball is the national game of Serbia, Lithuania and Estonia.

Q2. Which of the following is not a percussion instrument?

- A) Ghatam
- B) Tabla
- C) mridangam
- D) sarod**

Solution: 11.(d) The percussion family of musical instruments consists of membranophones and idiophones. Examples- Ghatam, Tabla, Mridangam, timpani, xylophone, cymbals, snare drum, bass drum, tambourine, maracas, gongs, chimes, celesta, and piano. Sarod, stringed musical instrument of the lute family.

Q3. In which of the following Indian states will you find the Tibetan Buddhist Golden Temple?

- A) Sikkim
- B) Karnataka**
- C) Himachal Pradesh
- D) Tamil Nadu

Solution: 13.(b) Penor Rinpoche is the founder of the Tibetan Buddhist Golden Temple located at Arlikumari, Bylakuppe, Karnataka. 12 Famous Buddhist temple and monasteries In India are Mahabodhi Temple, Bodhi Gaya, Mahaparinirvana Temple, Kushinagar, Ramadhan Stupa Temple, Kushinagar, Wat Thai Temple, Kushinagar, Thikse Monastery, Leh, Mindrolling Monastery, Dehradun, Ghum Monastery, Darjeeling, Namdroling Monastery & Golden Temple, Mysore, Rumtek Monastery, Gangtok, Tsuglagkhang Temple Complex, Dharamsala, Dhamekh Stupa, Sarnath, Vishwa Shanti Stupa, Rajgir.

Q4. Which of the following terms is NOT related with cricket? I. Runs II. Dribbling

- A) Both I and II
- B) Neither I nor II
- C) Only I
- D) Only II**

Solution: 9.(d) Only II. Cricket is a bat-and-ball game played between two teams of eleven players on a field at the center of which is a 22-yard pitch with a wicket at each end, each comprising two bails balanced on three stumps. Cricket Terms - Bouncer, Boundary, Chinaman, Dead ball, Economy rate, and leg before wicket (LBW).

Q5. _____, originating from Kerala in Southern India, derives its name from Mohini, a mythological enchantress.

- A) Manipuri Dance
- B) Bihu Dance
- C) Mohiniyattam**
- D) Bharatanatyam

Solution: 14.(c) Mohiniattam is characterized by its graceful and flowing movements, and is often performed to tell stories from Hindu mythology. Famous exponents : Kalamandalam Kalyanikutty Amma, Thankamony, Krishna Panicker and Mukundraja, Sunanda Nair, Smitha Rajan, etc. Bharatanatyam, a classical dance from Tamil Nadu, highlights emotion, music, rhythm, and intricate movements. It often tells stories from Hindu mythology through expressive hand gestures and footwork.

Q6. Which of the following is a book written by Avni Doshi?

- A) In Other Words
- B) Burnt Sugar**

- C) Unaccustomed Earth
- D) Interpreter of Maladies

Solution: 8.(b) Books written by Avni Doshi are 'Burnt Sugar' and 'Girl in white Cotton'. 'In Other Words', 'Unaccustomed Earth', 'Interpreter of Maladies' - Jhumpa Lahiri,

Q7. Which city hosted the 2018 Asian games?

- A) Bangkok
- B) Tokyo
- C) Jakarta and Palembang**
- D) Hangzhou

Solution: 2.(c) Jakarta and Palembang (Indonesia). Host cities & countries of the Asian Games: 1951 (First edition) - New Delhi (India), 1954 - Manila (Philippines), 1966 - Bangkok (Thailand), 1982 - New Delhi, 2002 - Busan (South Korea), 2022 - Hangzhou (China), 2026 - Aichi and Nagoya (Japan), 2030 - Doha (Qatar).

Q8. Who among the following was the first Dr Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar awardee?

- A) MN Saha
- B) KS Krishnan**
- C) CV Raman
- D) S Chandrasekhar

Solution: 6.(b) KS Krishnan was the first Dr Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar awardee. The purpose of the award is to recognise outstanding Indian work in science and technology.

Q9. In which of the following states is the Hornbill festival celebrated?

- A) Nagaland**
- B) Manipur
- C) Assam
- D) Mizoram

Solution: 3.(a) Nagaland. Hornbill festival is celebrated annually in the first week of December. It is celebrated by the Naga tribe. It takes place at Kisama Heritage Village, around 12 km from Kohima (Capital city). It began in 2000. Other festivals in the state are Sekrenyi and Aoleang.

Q10. A football match is played by two teams, each with a maximum of _____.

- A) eleven players**
- B) ten players
- C) five players
- D) seven players

Solution: 11.(a) eleven players. Sports and Number of Players: Cricket (11), Basketball (5), Volleyball (6), Hockey (11), Baseball (9), Handball (7), Water Polo (7), Kabaddi (7), and Kho Kho (9).

Q11. Radha Sridhar is associated with which of the following classical dance?

- A) Sattriya
- B) Bharatnatyam**
- C) Kathak
- D) Manipuri

Solution: 7.(b) Bharatnatyam. Her Award - Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (2018). Other Exponents of Bharatnatyam - Mrinalini Sarabhai, Mallika Sarabhai, Padma Subramanyam, Yamini Krishnamurthy and Anita Ratnam. Exponents of Indian Classical Dances: Kathak - Pandit Birju Maharaj, Roshan Kumari, Shovana Narayan, and Kumudini Lakhia; Manipuri - Guru Bipin Singh, Darshana Jhaveri, and Charu Mathur; Sattriya - Guru Jatini Goswami, Guru Ghanakanta Bora, and Bhabananda Barabayan.

Q12. 'Ummatt-aat' is a folk dance form performed in _____.

- A) Kasauli
- B) Coorg**
- C) Itanagar

D) Gangtok

Solution: 9.(b) 'Ummatt-aat' is a folk dance form performed in Coorg. There are many other traditional dance forms of Karnataka which include Dollu Kuniha, Suggi Kuniha, Kamsale, Gorava Kuniha, Somana Kuniha, Bolak-aat, Komb-aat, Bhootha Aradhane, Yaksha Gana, Naga Mandala, Veeragase.

Q13. Which of the following state is associated with Kathak?

A) Uttar Pradesh

B) Kerala

C) Andhra Pradesh

D) Bihar

Solution: 10.(a) Uttar Pradesh. The Sangeet Natak Academy recognizes eight classical dances: Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Odissi (Odisha), Kathakali and Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Sattriya (Assam), Manipuri (Manipur), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh). Additionally, the Indian Ministry of Culture includes Chhau in its list, recognising nine total styles.

Q14. Sangeet Natak Academy Awards were earlier known as _____.

A) Residential Awards

B) Prestigious Awards

C) Presidential Awards

D) Cultural Awards

Solution: 9.(c) Presidential Awards. The awards for Hindustani and Carnatic music were instituted as early as 1951, even before the establishment of the Sangeet Natak Akademi, and were originally known as Presidential Awards. After the Akademi was formed, these awards became the Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards, with the responsibility for their investiture transferred to the Akademi. The Presidential Awards for 1952 and 1953 were later included in the list of Sangeet Natak Akademi Awards.

Q15. Who among the following is related to the musical instrument Santoor?

A) Pandit Shivkumar Sharma

B) Pandit Ravishankar Prasad

C) Pandit Hariprasad Chaurasia

D) Pandit Jasraj

Solution: 13.(a) Pandit Shivkumar Sharma was a Santoor player. Awards and Honors: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1986), the Padma Shri (1991), and the Padma Vibhushan (2001). As a music composer, he collaborated with Indian flutist Hariprasad Chaurasia under the collaborative name Shiv-Hari. Pandit Ravishankar Prasad (Sitar player) and Pandit Jasraj (tabla player).

Q16. A famous play, 'Abhijnana Shakuntalam' was written by which of the following personalities ?

A) Kalhana

B) Asvaghosa

C) Kalidasa

D) Vishakhadatta

Solution: 15.(c) Kalidasa: He wrote 'Abhijnana Shakuntalam' in Sanskrit language. Other famous plays written by Kalidasa : 'Meghaduta', 'Raghuvamsa', 'Malavikagnimitram', 'Vikramorvasiyam', 'Kumarasambhava', 'Ritusamhara'. Personalities and their Plays : Kalhana - 'Rajatarangini'. Asvaghosa - 'Buddhacharitra'. Vishakhadatta - 'MudraRakshasa' and 'Devichandraguptam'.

Q17. In which of the following years was the Fit India Movement launched by Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports, GoI?

A) 2018

B) 2001

C) 2020

D) 2019

Solution: 15.(d) Fit India Movement was launched in 2019 on the occasion of National Sports Day to make fitness an integral part of the daily lives of the people of India. National Sports Day is celebrated on 29 August every year, on the birth anniversary of hockey legend Major Dhyan Chand.

Q18. Which instrument was played by Ustad Asad Ali Khan ?

A) Sarod

B) Santoor

C) Sitar

D) Rudra Veena

Solution: 13.(d) Rudra Veena. Ustad Asad Ali Khan was an expert in the Khandar school of Dhrupad (Hindustani Classical Music). Awards : Padma Bhushan (2008). Other Rudra-veena players : Bnade Ali Khan, Abid Hussain Khan, Rajab Ali Khan, Krishna Rao Kollapure, Wazir Khan, Zia Mohiuddin Dagar, Bahauddin Dagar.

Q19. In which of the following states of India is the Nongkrem festival celebrated ?

A) Rajasthan

B) Madhya Pradesh

C) Tamil Nadu

D) Meghalaya

Solution: 13.(d) Meghalaya. The Nongkrem dance festival is celebrated during Autumn at Smit, the cultural centre of the Khasi Hills. It is a five day long religious festival of the Khasis. Other festivals of Meghalaya : Shad Suk Mynsiem, Behdienkhlam Festival, Shad Sukra, Wangala Festival, Strawberry Festival.

Q20. Who among the following addressed the World Parliament of Religions at Chicago in 1893?

A) Swami Vivekananda

B) Ishwarchandra Vidyasagar

C) Swami Dayanand Saraswati

D) Raja Rammohun Roy

Solution: 12.(a) Swami Vivekananda (Narendranath Datta). He was born on 12th January 1863 in Calcutta. In 1893, upon the request of Maharaja Ajit Singh of the Khetri State, he took the name 'Vivekananda'. He was the chief disciple of the Ramakrishna Paramhansa and established the Ramakrishna Mission in 1897. In 1899, he established the Belur Math, which became his permanent abode. He died at Belur Math in 1902.

Q21. Which dance form from Karnataka involves large drums hung around the necks of men and is known for its religious and battle fervour ?

A) Ghodemodni

B) Kummi

C) Dandiya

D) Dollu Kuniha

Solution: 7.(d) Dollu Kuniha. It is associated with the worship of Sree Beeralingeswara (Lord Shiva), originated in the rituals of the Kuruba Gowda community of North Karnataka. Other folk dances: Kamsale Nrutya (Karnataka), Ghodemodni (Goa), Kummi (Kerala, Tamil Nadu), Dandiya (Gujarat).

Q22. Players that stop dribbling in handball have to pass or shot within:

A) 5 second

B) 30 second

C) 10 second

D) 3 second

Solution: 12.(d) If a handball player takes more than three steps without dribbling (bouncing the ball) or holds the ball for more than 3 seconds without bouncing it, shooting or passing, then that is deemed 'walking' and possession is lost. Terminology used in Handball: Court player, Goalie, Corner Throw, Free throw, Penalty throw, Referee's throw, Dive shot, Goal, Throw-in, Throw-on, Throw out, etc.

Q23. _____ is a vocal form of music from the state of Punjab.

A) Qawwali

B) Ghazal

C) Tappa

D) Bhajan

Solution: 5.(c) Tappa is a vocal form of music from the state of Punjab. Qawwali is religious Sufi music that celebrates devotion and one's relationship with God. The ghazal is a form of amatory poem or ode, originating in Arabic poetry. Bhajan refers to any devotional song with a religious theme or spiritual ideas, specifically among Indian religions, in any

language.

Q24. According to census 2011, which is the least populous state in India?

- A) Nagaland
- B) Sikkim**
- C) Arunachal Pradesh
- D) Goa

Solution: 9.(b) According to the 2011 Census, 5 least populous states of India: Sikkim, Mizoram, Arunachal Pradesh, Goa, and Nagaland. 5 most populous states of India: Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Bihar, West Bengal, and Andhra Pradesh.

Q25. _____ is one of the languages in which the denomination is printed on the reverse of a contemporary Indian currency note.

- A) Burmese
- B) Sinhala
- C) Nepali**
- D) Dzongkha

Solution: 10.(c) Nepali is one of the languages in which the denomination is printed on the reverse of a contemporary Indian currency note. Sinhala, is an Indo-Aryan language primarily spoken by the Sinhalese people of Sri Lanka. Dzongkha is a Sino-Tibetan language spoken in Bhutan. Burmese is a Sino-Tibetan language spoken in Myanmar.

Q26. Kathak dance is known as a combination of _____ .

- A) Music and narrative only
- B) Music and drama only
- C) Music and dance only
- D) Music, dance and narrative**

Solution: 5.(d) Music, dance and narrative. Kathak is one of the classical dances of India. The word Kathak has been derived from the word Katha which means a story. It is mainly performed in Northern India and often portrays the legends of Radha and Krishna. Notable Kathak dancers are Pandit Birju Maharaj and Sitara Devi.

Q27. Who among the following wrote the novel 'The Great Gatsby'?

- A) Chinua Achebe
- B) Harper Lee
- C) F Scott Fitzgerald**
- D) Alice Walker

Solution: 19.(c) F Scott Fitzgerald wrote the novel 'The Great Gatsby'. Chinua Achebe is most famous for his novel 'Things Fall Apart'. Harper Lee is most famous for her novel 'To Kill a Mockingbird'. Alice Walker's most famous work is the Pulitzer Prize-winning novel 'The Color Purple'.

Q28. Which iconic Indian classical vocalist, often known as the "Mewati Maestro," is celebrated for his mastery of khayal singing and his innovative approach to ragas ?

- A) Pandit Jasraj**
- B) Hariprasad Chaurasia
- C) Zakir Hussain
- D) Bismillah Khan

Solution: 3.(a) Pandit Jasraj. His Awards: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1987), Padma Bhushan (1990), Padma Vibhushan (2000), Swathi Sangeetha Puraskaram (2008). Other Maestro - Hariprasad Chaurasia (flute player), Zakir Hussain (tabla player), Bismillah Khan (Shehnai player).

Q29. In which year did India host the second Asian Games?

- A) 1978
- B) 1980
- C) 1999
- D) 1982**

Solution: 5.(d) 1982. The Asian Games are organized by the Olympic Council of Asia (OCA) every four years. India hosted the first Asian Games in 1951. Thailand has hosted the most Asian Games, in 1966, 1970, 1978, and 1998. The 20th Asian Games (2026) will be held in Nagoya, Japan.

Q30. Which of the following sports is played by Mouma Das ?

- A) Table Tennis**
- B) Hockey
- C) Cricket
- D) Badminton

Solution: 8.(a) Table Tennis. Mouma Das became only the second table tennis player after Achanta Sharath Kamal (2019) to win the Padma Shri (2021). Her Awards : Arjuna Award (2013). Other table tennis players: Manika Batra, Sathiyan Gnanasekaran, Manav Thakkar.

Q31. Kuchipudi originated in a village named Kuchipudi in the Indian state of _____.

- A) Kerala
- B) Tamil Nadu
- C) Andhra Pradesh**
- D) Uttar Pradesh

Solution: 14.(c) Andhra Pradesh. Kuchipudi is an Indian classical dance originated from Kuchipudi village in the Krishna district in Andhra Pradesh. Other classical dances and respective states: Bharatnatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Kathakali (Kerala), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Mohiniyattam (Kerala), Odissi (Odisha), Sattriya (Assam); Manipuri (Manipur).

Q32. The Maharashtra Department of Prisons has launched a loan scheme for inmates serving sentences in jails across the state. This credit scheme is titled _____.

- A) Jivhala**
- B) Kishore
- C) Sukanya
- D) Swavlamban

Solution: 2.(a) A loan scheme named Jivhala has been launched for the inmates who are facing a sentence of more than three years in various jails across Maharashtra. This scheme was launched for the prisoners who are in the Yerawada Central Jail, Pune. The interest rate that will be applicable is 7 percent. Sukanya scheme (fund for girls, launched in 2015). Swavalamban scheme (launched in 2010, replaced by Atal Pension Yojana (2015)).

Q33. Which of the following festivals is celebrated by the Khamtis tribe of Arunachal Pradesh

- A) Mopin
- B) Sangken**
- C) Reh
- D) Tam ladu

Solution: 15.(b) Sangken is a socio-religious festival celebrated by the Khamti and Singpho tribes, who follow the Theravada Buddhist sect. It marks the advent of spring and is observed annually in April (Naun-Haa) according to the Khamti calendar. Mopin is an agricultural festival widely celebrated by the Galo tribes of Arunachal Pradesh, while Reh is widely observed by the Idu tribes of the same region.

Q34. Who among the following is the author of the epic poem 'Kamayani'?

- A) Jaishankar Prasad**
- B) Gopala Sarana Sinha
- C) Mahadevi Varma
- D) Mahavir Prasad Dwivedi

Solution: 18.(a) The author of the epic poem 'Kamayani' is Jaishankar Prasad. Jaishankar Prasad's most famous dramas include 'Skandagupta', 'Chandragupta' and 'Dhruvaswamini'. Some of the famous books are 'Titli', 'Kankal', 'Inderjaal', 'Ajatshatru', 'Mamta'.

Q35. The couple who won Padma Bhushan in 2009 for Bharatanatyam are _____.

- A) Krishna Ella and Suchitra Ella
- B) K.V. Sampath Kumar and Vidushi K.S. Jayalakshmi
- C) Vannadil Pudiya veetil Dhananjayan and Shanta Dhananjayan**
- D) Mahaboob Subhani and Kaleeshabi Mahboob

Solution: 7.(c) Some famous Bharatanatyam exponents include T.

Balasaraswati, Kumari Kamala, Sucheta Bhide Chapekar, Yamini Krishnamurthy, Saroja Vaidyanathan, Alarmel Valli, Geeta Chandran, and Mallika Sarabhai.

Q36. Which of the following is an indigenous dairy breed of cattle?

- A) Red Sindhi
- B) Chippiparai
- C) Kanni
- D) Kombai

Solution: 1.(a) Red Sindhi is a reputed heat tolerant milch cattle breed originating from Sindh province of Pakistan. The Chippiparai is a breed of sighthound from Tamil Nadu in southern India. The Kanni is a rare indigenous South Indian sighthound breed of dog. The Kombai or Polygar dog is a breed of sighthound native to Tamil Nadu

Q37. PR Sreejesh is a _____

- A) hockey player
- B) football player
- C) cricket player
- D) badminton player

Solution: 12.(a) Hockey player. He has represented India in four consecutive Olympic Games: 2012, 2016, 2020, and 2024. He made his debut as a goalkeeper at the 2006 South Asian Games in Sri Lanka. Other Indian hockey players: Jarmanpreet Singh, Amit Rohidas, Harmanpreet Singh, Sumit Walmiki, Shamsher Singh, Manpreet Singh, Vivek Sagar Prasad, Abhishek Nain, Sukhjeet Singh, Lalit Kumar Upadhyay, Mandeep Singh.

Q38. Where is the Sair-E-Gul Faroshan festival held?

- A) Mussoorie
- B) Mumbai
- C) Delhi
- D) Shimla

Solution: 8.(c) Sair - e - gul faroshan festival (Phool Waalon Ki Sair) is an annual celebration by the flower sellers of Delhi. It is a three-day festival, generally held in the month of September, just after the rainy season in the region of Mehrauli. The origin of this festival goes to 1812, during the reign of the Mughal King Akbar Shah II (1808 -1837). It was stopped by the British during the Quit India Movement of Mahatma Gandhi in 1942. It was revived in 1961 - 62, during the tenure of the then Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru.

Q39. The "Thrissur Pooram" is a famous temple festival celebrated in which Indian state, known for its elaborate processions and fireworks displays ?

- A) Tamil Nadu
- B) Orissa
- C) Kerala
- D) Karnataka

Solution: 4.(c) Kerala. Thrissur Pooram festival is held in the months of April - May in Vaddakumthathan Temple in the town of Thrissur. Popular Festivals in Kerala: Onam, Boat Festival, Attukal Pongala, Vishu, Makaravilakku at Sabarimala temple, Theyyam.

Q40. Rajashree Shirke was given which of the following prestigious dance awards of 2013 for her excellence in Kathak?

- A) Sangeet Natak Academy Award
- B) Padma Shri
- C) Kalidas Samman
- D) National Film Award

Solution: 10.(a) Rajashree Shirke (kathak dancer) won Sangeet Natak Academy Award in 2013. Awards and Honors: Mumbai Mayor's Award for Women Achievers of the Year, Best Shikshak for the year 2007, and Title "Khosrovani" by Halim Academy of Sitar. Shambhu Maharaj was the first Kathak dancer to win Sangeet Natak Academy Award in 1955.

Q41. Rukmini Devi is regarded as one of the most distinguished artists of _____.

- A) Bharatanatyam

- B) Kathakali
- C) Mohiniattam
- D) Bhortal Dance

Solution: 10.(a) Bharatanatyam. Rukmini Devi Arundale - The first woman in Indian history to be nominated as a member of the Rajya Sabha. She established the Kalakshetra Foundation at Adyar, Chennai. Her award: Padma Bhushan (1956). Other Exponents of Bharatanatyam: Meenakshi Sundaram Pillai, T. Balasaraswati, Alarmel Valli, and Yamini Krishnamurthy.

Q42. Birju Maharaj was awarded which of the following awards in 2012?

- A) Sangam Kala Award
- B) Filmfare Award
- C) National Film Award
- D) Sangeet Natak Akademi Award

Solution: 5.(c) Pandit Birju Maharaj was an exponent of the Lucknow ``Kalka-Bindadin " Gharana of Kathak dance in India. Awards and Honours: National Film Award for Best Choreography for Unnai Kaanaathu (2012), Filmfare Award for Best Choreography (2016), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1964), Padma Vibhushan (1986), Nritya Choodamani Award by Sri Krishna Gana Sabha (1986), Kalidas Samman (1987), Lata Mangeshkar Puraskar (2002), etc.

Q43. Gurpurab is celebrated by which of the following community ?

- A) Hindu
- B) Christian
- C) Sikh
- D) Parsi

Solution: 8.(c) Sikh. Gurpurab is celebrated in honour of the Sikh Gurus. Other Fairs and Festivals of Punjab - Lohri, Basant Panchami, Hola Mohalla, Maghi, Bandi Chhor Divas, and Baisakhi.

Q44. Gangaur festival is historically native to which of the following states"

- A) Himachal Pradesh
- B) Uttar Pradesh
- C) Madhya Pradesh
- D) Rajasthan

Solution: 11.(d) Rajasthan. The Gangaur festival is celebrated in the Hindu month of Chaitra, which is March and April. Other festivals of Rajasthan: Teej Festival, Desert Festival, Nagaur Fair, Marwar Festival, Camel Festival, Mewar Festival, Elephant Festival.

Q45. Which dance form originated in Andhra Pradesh ?

- A) Kuchipudi
- B) Kathak
- C) Bharatnatyam
- D) Sattriya

Solution: 14.(a) Kuchipudi is one of the eight major Indian classical dances. It originates from a village named Kuchipudi in Andhra Pradesh. List of Classical dances: Bharatanatyam (Tamil Nadu), Kathak (Uttar Pradesh), Kuchipudi (Andhra Pradesh), Odissi (Odisha), Kathakali (Kerala), Sattriya (Assam), Manipuri (Manipur), Mohiniyattam (Kerala).

Q46. Giddha dance is mainly related to:

- A) Punjab
- B) Bihar
- C) Gujarat
- D) West Bengal

Solution: 6.(a) Punjab. Giddha is performed by women. Famous Folk Dances of Punjab: Bhangra, Kikli, Jaago, Jhumar, Sammi, Gatra, Jindua, Malwai Giddha. State and their Folk dance: Bihar - Karma, Jharmi; Gujarat - Dandiya Raas, Garba, Bhavai; West Bengal - Brita, Tusu, Baul.

Q47. The Bhaja Caves are located in _____.

- A) Uttar Pradesh
- B) Maharashtra
- C) Rajasthan

D) Bihar

Solution: 2.(b) The Bhaja Caves are located in Maharashtra. Top 10 Historic Caves In Maharashtra Ajanta Caves, Ellora Caves, Elephanta Caves, Karla Caves, Bhaja Caves, Bedse Caves, Lenyadri Caves, Aurangabad Caves, Limestone Caves, bahrot caves.

Q48. On which Indian musician's life was the documentary film "Bansuri Guru" based on?

- A) T.H. Vinayakram
- B) Pandit Ravi Shankar
- C) Hari Prasad Chaurasia**
- D) Pandit Shivkumar Sharma

Solution: 8.(c) Hari Prasad Chaurasia, an Indian flutist associated with the Maihar Senia Gharana, has received several prestigious awards, including the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1983), the Padma Bhushan (1992), and the Padma Vibhushan (2000). Other famous flutists include Ronu Majumdar, Devendra Murdeshwar, Raghunath Seth, Pt. Rajendra Prasanna, and Chetan Joshi.

Q49. Which of the following is an Indian 'not for profit' organisation, working on sustainable solutions to make sanitation and water accessible to all?

- A) Pratham
- B) Helpage India
- C) Goonj
- D) Sulabh International**

Solution: 7.(d) Sulabh International was founded by Bindeshwar Pathak. Pratham is an innovative learning organization created to improve the quality of education in India. HelpAge India is an Indian organization focused on the concerns of elders. Goonj is channelising the unused material lying idle in urban homes, to the far-flung villages of India as an important economic resource.

Q50. Name the famous hockey player after which there is a stadium built in New Delhi.

- A) Dhanraj Pillay
- B) Sardar Singh
- C) Major Dhyan Chand**
- D) Balbir Singh

Solution: 5.(c) Major Dhyan Chand. The Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium was designed by Anthony S. DeMillo. It dates back to 1933 and was built as a gift for Delhi by the Maharaja of Bhavnagar. The "Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna Award" (previously known as the Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna Award) is named in his honor.

Q51. Which of the following sports is played by Indian player Sandeep Kumar ?

- A) Archery**
- B) Boxing
- C) Wrestling
- D) Cricket

Solution: 13.(a) Archery. Famous Indian archers: Pravin Jadhav, Atanu Das, Tarundeep Rai, Bombayla Devi Laishram, Dola Banerjee, Deepika Kumari, Jayanta Talukdar, etc.

Q52. Who of the following is famous for playing the musical instrument Kanjira?

- A) Kishan Maharaj
- B) Pannalal Ghosh
- C) Pudukkottai Dakshinamurthi Pillai**
- D) S.V. Rajarao

Solution: 4.(c) Pudukkottai Dakshinamurthi Pillai. His Awards: Kalaimamani award (1985), Sahitya Kala Parishad award (1992). Other Indian Kanjira players: Anandan Sivamani, Jamey Haddad, Natarajan Ganesh Kumar.

Q53. Free throw is the sport term of_____.

- A) Football

- B) Cricket
- C) Badminton
- D) Basketball**

Solution: 6.(d) Basketball. Sports and Terminologies: Basketball - Slam Dunk, Alley-oop, Bank Shot, Double Dribble, Hook Shot. Football - Corner Kick, Goalkeeper, Offside, Penalty Kick, Counterattack. Cricket - LBW, Hit Wicket, Googly, Dead Ball, Bouncer. Badminton - Alley, Baseline, Centerline, Drive, Drop Shot, Net Shot, Wood Shot, Push Shot, etc.

Q54. Which of the following players is associated with boxing?

- A) Archana Kamat
- B) Lovlina Borgohain**
- C) Hima Das
- D) Monica Batra

Solution: 4.(b) Lovlina Borgohain (Assam) became the third Indian boxer to win a medal at the Olympics, after winning the bronze medal at the 2020 Olympic Games. Awards and Honors: Asom Sourav (2nd highest civilian award of Assam, 2021), Arjuna Award (2020), Khel Ratna Award (2021). In 2022, she was appointed as deputy superintendent of police by the Assam Government. Archana Kamath (Table tennis), Hima das (Indian Sprinter), Manika Batra (Table Tennis player).

Q55. 'Ponung' and 'Tapu' are popular dance forms from the state of _____.

- A) Chhattisgarh
- B) Arunachal Pradesh**
- C) Goa
- D) Bihar

Solution: 16.(b) Ponung' and 'Tapu' are popular dance forms from the state of Arunachal Pradesh. Some popular folk dances in Arunachal Pradesh are Aji Lamu, Chalo, Hiirii Khaniing, Popir, Ponung, Pasi Kongki, Rekham Pada, Roppi, Lion and Peacock dance.

Q56. Which road plan in India was the first attempt for the Road Development Programme between 1943 - 1963?

- A) Poona Road Plan
- B) Nagpur Road Plan**
- C) Bombay Road Plan
- D) Lucknow Road Plan

Solution: 6.(b) The first 20-year road plan is called the Nagpur Road plan (1943 - 1963), Road density = 16 km/100 km², Road pattern = star and grid pattern, and Development allowance = 15%. Road Classification: National Highway, State Highway, Major District Roads, Other district roads, and Village roads. Bombay road plan (1961- 1981, Road density = 32 km/100 km², Development allowance = 5%, and Length of expressways = 1600 km). Lucknow road plan (1981 – 2001) : Road density = 82 km/100 km², Road pattern = Square grid, and Length of expressways = 2000 km).

Q57. Roshan Kumari is an exponent of which Indian classical dance form?

- A) Kathak**
- B) Odissi
- C) Bharatanatyam
- D) Kathakali

Solution: 7.(a) Roshan Kumari Fakir Mohammad is one of the exponents of Kathak dance. She follows the Jaipur Gharana and is the founder of Nritya Kala Kendra, Mumbai. Awards and Honors: Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1975), Nritya Vilas honor (1977), Padma Shri (1984), Vishwa Unnnyan Samsad (1989), Maharashtra Gaurav Puraskar (1990), Man Patra honor (Kathak Kendra, Jaipur in 1993), All India Bhuwalka Award (2005) and the Hanumant Award (2008).

Q58. Match the following personalities with their associated musical instrument: A) S. Balachander B) Anushka Shankar C) Kishan Maharaj 1

- Tabla 2 Veena 3 Sitar**
- A) A-1, B-3, C-2
- B) A-2, B-1, C-3
- C) A-1, B-2, C-3
- D) A-2, B-3, C-1**

Solution: 1.(d) A-2, B-3, C-1. Musical instruments and their exponents:
Tabla - Zakir Hussain, Ahmed Jan Thirakwa, Swapan Chaudhuri, Anindo Chatterjee, Alla Rakha. Veena - Rajhesh Vaidhya, Jayanthi Kumaresh, Veena E. Gayathri, Nageswara Rao. Sitar - Ravi Shankar, Anoushka Shankar, Vilayat Khan, Shahid Parvez, Nikhil Banerjee.

Q59. _____ in Indian Dance is given in recognition of excellence and achievement in performance or research studies in Indian Dance.

A) The Manorama Thakkar Award

- B) The Uday Shankar Award
- C) The Rukmini Devi Award
- D) The Nritya Choodamani Award

Solution: 12.(a) The Manorama Thakkar Award. Rukmini Devi Arundale was a trailblazer in the world of Bharatanatyam. Uday Shankar was an Indian dancer and choreographer, best known for creating a fusion style of dance. The Nritya Choodamani Award is given to artists who have made outstanding contributions to their art form and society through their dedication and performances.

Q60. Which of the following dances is performed by women on various occasions to the beating of a drum in Madhya Pradesh?

A) Matki dance

- B) Mundari
- C) Rouf
- D) Bhagoria

Solution: 1.(a) Matki dance - Women balance earthen pots on their heads while dancing. Other folk dance of Madhya Pradesh: Tertali- Performed by two or three women sitting on the ground. Lehangi - A dance of the Banjara and Kanjar tribes, performed during the monsoon. Akiri Dance - A signature dance of the cattle herders in Gwalior. Bhagoriya - It is a dance of the Bhils tribe.

Q61. An exponent of Hindustani classical music, Gangubai Hangal was an eminent singer to have hailed from the _____ gharana of the Hindustani Khyal family.

- A) Patiala
- B) Kirana**
- C) Agra
- D) Gwalior

Solution: 11.(b) Gangubai Hangal (Karnataka) belonged to the Kirana gharana. Awards and Honors: Karnataka Sangeetha Nritya Academy Award (1962), Padma Bhushan (1971), Sangeet Natak Akademi Award (1973), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1996), and Padma Vibhushan (2002).

Q62. Which of the following pair of sports persons-sports associated with is correct ? I. Smriti Mandhana - Hockey II. Jyothi Yarraji - Cricket

- A) Only I
- B) Only II
- C) Neither I nor II**
- D) Both I and II

Solution: 2.(c) Neither I nor II. Smriti Mandhana won the Arjuna Award for Cricket in 2018. Jyothi Yarraji (Athletics) won a silver medal in the 2022 Asian Games, and Gold medal in 2024 Asian Indoor Athletics Championships.

Q63. In which year was the first edition of the Indian Premier League (IPL) cricket tournament held?

- A) 2015
- B) 2003
- C) 2008**
- D) 2018

Solution: 2.(c) 2008. The inaugural IPL season was won by Rajasthan Royals. There have been seventeen seasons of the IPL tournament (As of August, 2024). Mumbai Indians and Chennai Super Kings have each won five titles.

Q64. Who among the following was India's longest serving prime minister as of April 2021?

A) Jawaharlal Nehru

- B) Indira Gandhi
- C) IK Gujral
- D) Narendra Modi

Solution: 3.(a) Jawaharlal Nehru was India's longest serving prime minister. He served as the country's prime minister for 16 years, 286 days. Second longest serving Prime Minister is Smt Indira Gandhi for 11 years 59 days.

Q65. Which of the following is celebrated as the New Year in Tamil Nadu?

- A) Pongal
- B) Puthandu**
- C) Ugadi
- D) Onam

Solution: 14.(b) Puthandu (Puthuvaram, Tamil New Year), is the first day of the first Tamil month, Chittirai (14 April) on the Tamil calendar, celebrated as a festival by Tamil Hindus of Tamil Nadu and Puducherry. Pongal (Tai Pongal) is a 3 -4 days Hindu harvest festival celebrated by Tamils in India (Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Kerala, and Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Puducherry) and Sri Lanka. Ugadi festival (new year festival, celebrated in states of Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Telangana). Onam (Harvest festival of Kerala).

Q66. The rooftop of Guru Hemkund Sahib is in the shape of an upturned _____.

- A) lotus**
- B) sunflower
- C) rose
- D) marigold

Solution: 4.(a) The rooftop of Guru Hemkund Sahib is in the shape of an upturned lotus. Guru Hemkund Sahib located at Chamoli district of Uttarakhand.

Q67. During which of the following period Ostriches were found in India?

- A) Mesolithic
- B) Chalcolithic
- C) Neolithic
- D) Palaeolithic**

Solution: 1.(d) Ostriches were found in India during the Palaeolithic age. 'Negrito' race belongs to the Paleolithic Period also known as Old stone age or ice age (500,000 BCE – 10,000 BCE). Mesolithic Period (Late Stone Age): 10,000 BCE – 6000 BCE, Neolithic Period (New Stone Age): 6000 BCE – 1000 BCE, Chalcolithic Period (Stone Copper Age): 3000 BCE – 500 BCE, and Iron Age: 1500 BCE – 200 BCE.

Q68. The _____ festival of Sikkim is also known as Bhoomi Puja or Chandi Puja.

- A) Barahimizong
- B) Losar
- C) Indra Jatra
- D) Sakewa**

Solution: 15.(d) Sakewa is a religious festival for the Kirat Khambu Rai community in Sikkim. Barahimizong is a festival observed by the Mangar Community in Sikkim. Losar is celebrated by the Buddhist Community in the Ladakh region. Indra Jatra is the celebration of God Indra's Day. Indra Jatra is a festival of Kathmandu, the capital of Nepal.

Q69. Which instrument is played by Pandit Ravi Shankar?

- A) Sarod
- B) Guitar
- C) Sitar**
- D) Tabla

Solution: 6.(c) Sitar. His awards: Bharat Ratna (1999), Padma Vibhushan (1981), and Padma Bhushan (1967). Exponents of Various Musical Instruments: Sitar - Nikhil Banerjee, Manilal Nag, and Mustaq Ali Khan; Sarod - Amjad Ali Khan, Allaudin Khan, and Ustad Ali Akbar Khan; Tabla - Allah Rakha, Pt. Kishan Maharaj.

Q70. Which one is the Traditional Celebrations of Kerala ?

- A) Nag Panchami
B) Hornbill Festival
C) Baisakhi
D) Onam

Solution: 11.(d) Onam is a harvest festival celebrated in the months of August-September. Other festivals of Kerala include Thrissur Pooram, the Boat Festival, Attukal Pongala, Vishu, Makaravilakku, and the Theyyam Festival.

Q71. South Asian leaders signed the SAARC Charter at the first summit in _____ in the year 1985.

- A) Colombo
B) Dhaka
C) Delhi
D) Thimphu

Solution: 12.(b) South Asian leaders signed the SAARC Charter at the first summit in Dhaka in the year 1985. SAARC member countries are Afghanistan, Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan, and Sri Lanka. It is an economic and political organization

Q72. In any tennis game, any game starts at 0-0 and the zero point in tennis is called _____.

- A) origin
B) start
C) love
D) base

Solution: 15.(c) love. The word Love (for zero score) comes from the French word l'oeuf – which means egg which is in the shape of zero. Common tennis terms: ACE, Backhand, Advantage, Deuce, Double fault, Forehand, Alley, Baseline, Break Point, Fault, Serve, Drop Shot.

Q73. Fouaad Mirza is an Indian _____

- A) golfer
B) boxer
C) cricketer
D) equestrian

Solution: 14.(d) Fouaad Mirza is an Indian equestrian. An equestrian is someone who is involved with horses.

Q74. Hockey India, under the Ministry of _____, is the governing body responsible for planning and implementing all activities related to men's and women's hockey in India

- A) Games
B) Education
C) Youth Affairs and Sports
D) Child Development

Solution: 1.(c) Youth Affairs and Sports. Hockey India was recognized as the National Sports Federation by the Ministry of Youth Affairs & Sports, Government of India, in 2014, as the sole body responsible for promoting hockey in India. Its headquarters is located in New Delhi.

Q75. _____ is a storytelling classical dance form from Andhra Pradesh.

- A) Kathak
B) Sattriya
C) Manipuri
D) Kuchipudi

Solution: 3.(d) Kuchipudi is a classical Indian dance form that originated in the village of Kuchipudi, located in Andhra Pradesh. Classical Dances of India with States: Bharatanatyam - Tamil Nadu, Kathak - Uttar Pradesh,

Odissi - Odisha, Kathakali & Mohiniyattam - Kerala, Sattriya - Assam, and Manipuri - Manipur.

Q76. Heptathlon for women includes _____ events.

- A) 11
B) 7
C) 5
D) 10

Solution: 10.(b) 7. The “combined events” includes the decathlon for men and the heptathlon for women. Heptathlon (Women): Consists of 7 events - 100 m hurdles, high jump, shot put, 200 m, long jump, javelin throw, and 800 m. Decathlon (Men): Consists of 10 events - 100 m, shot put, high jump, long jump, 400 m, 110 m hurdles, discus throw, pole vault, javelin throw, and 1500 m.

Q77. Which of the following dancers of India won the Sangeet Natak Akademi Award for Folk and Tribal dance in the year 2018?

- A) Arjun Singh Dhurwey**
B) Gopika Varma
C) Dr. Aruna Mohanty
D) Tapan Kumar Pattanayak

Solution: 4.(a) Arjun Singh Dhurwey is famous for popularising Baiga folk songs and dance. The Baiga Pardhauni dance is the main dance of the Baiga tribe. In this form of dance, the performers wear the masks of peacocks, elephants, horses, etc. He received the Tulsi Samman Award from the Madhya Pradesh government and the Padma Shri in 2022.

Q78. In which state is the Maihar court where Baba Allauddin Khan was a musician?

- A) Tripura
B) Uttar Pradesh
C) Madhya Pradesh
D) Chhattisgarh

Solution: 3.(c) Maihar State (princely state) was located in today's Madhya Pradesh state of India. Baba Allauddin Khan (Sarod player) laid the foundation of Maihar Gharana and became the court musician for the Maharaja of Maihar. Award and Honors: Padma Bhushan (1958), Padma Vibhushan (1971), Sangeet Natak Akademi Fellowship (1954).

Q79. Before being renamed, Mount Everest was simply known as _____.

- A) Peak IX
B) Peak XV
C) Peak
D) Peak VI

Solution: 17.(b) Before being renamed, Mount Everest was simply known as Peak XV. Mount Everest is a peak in the Himalayan mountain range. It is located between Nepal and Tibet. The mountain was named after George Everest, a former Surveyor General of India. The Tibetan name is Chomolungma, which means “Mother Goddess of the World.” The Nepali name is Sagarmatha.

Q80. Which sport is played by the Indian sportsperson Anjum Chopra ?

- A) Lawn Tennis
B) Cricket
C) Badminton
D) Football

Solution: 9.(b) Cricket. Sports and their personalities: Cricket - Harmanpreet Kaur, Shafali Verma, Smriti Mandhana. Tennis - Sania Mirza, Rohan Bopanna, Mahesh Bhupathi. Badminton - Saina Nehwal, PV Sindhu, Prakash Padukone. Football - Sunil Chhetri, Gurmeet Singh, Bhaichung Bhutia.